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UAE Presidential Court

MOHAMED, MODI DISCUSS REGIONAL DEVELOPMENTS

President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan receives Narendra Modi, Prime Minister of India, at the Presidential Airport. During the discussions, PM Modi strongly condemned any targeting of the UAE in the ongoing regional conflict, reiterating India's support for peace and stability in the region. Modi expressed gratitude to the UAE leadership for ensuring the safety and well-being of Indian nationals during the West Asia conflict, praising the care extended to the community.

SEE ALSO P8

UAE landlords can check tenants' credit scores through UAE PASS

New system lets tenants securely share credit data before renting homes

DUBAI
BY JUSTIN VARGHESE
Your Money Editor

Private landlords in the UAE can now request the credit scores of prospective tenants through a new digital screening service launched by Etihad Credit Bureau in collaboration with UAE PASS.

The new "Tenant Screening" solution allows landlords to access a tenant's credit score only after the tenant gives approval through UAE PASS, the country's national digital identity platform.

The service is now available through the Etihad Credit

The new 'Tenant Screening' solution allows landlords to access a tenant's credit score only after the tenant gives approval through UAE PASS.

Bureau mobile app after being previewed at GITEX 2025 by the Telecommunications and Digital Government Regulatory Authority (TDRA) and Digital Dubai.

The move is expected to affect thousands of UAE residents searching for rental homes, as landlords increasingly seek financial checks before signing tenancy contracts.

Etihad Credit Bureau said the system is designed to improve transparency and confidence in the rental market

while giving residents greater control over how their financial data is shared.

Consent-based process

The platform works through a consent-based process. Landlords can send a request for a tenant's credit score, but the information is only released after approval through UAE PASS.

The bureau also announced upgrades to its existing Cheque Clearance Indicator feature, which now uses artificial intelligence to help cheque recipients assess the likelihood of a cheque being cleared based on the issuer's credit records.

Officials said the combined services could help reduce financial risks linked to rental disputes, bounced cheques and delayed payments in the real estate sector.

Over 167,000 Golden Visas for skilled families in Dubai

Data shows emirate's appeal for families, talent and investors

DUBAI
BY AGHADDIR ALI
Senior Reporter

More than 167,000 Golden Visas were issued to families of specialised talents, while over 100,286 residencies were granted to families of real estate investors. as Dubai recorded strong growth in family residency permits and Golden Residency applications in recent years.

Data released by the General Directorate of Identity and Foreigners Affairs – Dubai (GDRFA Dubai) showed sustained growth in family residency permits between 2021 and the first quarter of

2026, reflecting increasing confidence in Dubai's social and service infrastructure.

Many categories

Authorities also issued more than 70,247 residencies to families of scientists and specialists, 37,022 to families of investors, and 3,259 to families of retirees. Thousands of additional residencies were granted to entrepreneurs, humanitarian pioneers and outstanding students.

According to GDRFA Dubai, family-focused digital services now include visit visas for relatives and friends, residency issuance for family members, passport issuance and renewal, replacement of lost or damaged passports, amendments to family book records, and issuance of movement reports and certificates.

SEE ALSO P5

UAE CONDEMNS TERROR ATTACK ON NUCLEAR PLANT

Calls it threat to national, regional security

DUBAI
BY STEPHEN N. R.
Senior Associate Editor

The UAE yesterday strongly condemned an unprovoked terrorist drone attack targeting an electricity generator outside the inner perimeter of the Barakah Nuclear Power Plant in the Al Dhafra region, warning that the strike represented a dangerous escalation and a direct threat to national and regional security.

In a statement, the Ministry of Foreign Affairs (MoFA) said the drone entered the country's territory from the western border direction and struck the generator without causing injuries or affecting radiation safety levels at the plant. The Ministry described the attack as "an unacceptable act of aggression" and stressed that targeting peaceful nuclear energy facilities constitutes a flagrant violation of international law, the UN Charter and humanitarian principles because of the grave risks such actions pose to civilians, the environment and regional stability.

UAE's right to respond

The UAE also emphasised that international agreements and International Atomic Energy Agency (IAEA) principles clearly require the protection of peaceful nuclear facilities from hostile acts and military threats.

"The UAE will not tolerate any threat to its security and sovereignty under any circumstance," the ministry said, adding that the country reserves its full sovereign, legitimate, diplomatic and military rights to respond to threats or hostilities in accordance with international law.

IRAN AGGRESSION IN FOCUS AT ATHENS

Dr Anwar Mohammed Gargash, Diplomatic Adviser to the UAE President, highlighted the importance of GCC-European partnerships in strengthening stability, security and peace. In a post on X, Gargash said the discussions at the European-Gulf summit, held in Athens, Greece, included an in-depth dialogue on the political and economic impact of the Iranian aggression, as well as the broader consequences of the conflict and its aftermath.

— **Khitam Al Amir,**
Chief News Editor

Earlier, the Ministry of Defence said the UAE's air defence systems intercepted three drones that entered the country from the western border direction. According to the ministry, two drones were successfully intercepted, while the third struck the electricity generator outside the Barakah plant's inner perimeter. Authorities said investigations were under way to determine the source of the attack and that further details would be announced once inquiries were completed.

The ministry added that the UAE remained fully prepared to confront any threats aimed at undermining the country's security, sovereignty and stability.

The UN nuclear watchdog later expressed "grave concern" over the drone strike near the UAE nuclear facility, though it confirmed that radiation levels remained normal.

Flagrant violation

Meanwhile, Sheikh Abdullah Bin Zayed Al Nahyan, Deputy Prime Minister and Minister of Foreign Affairs, during a phone call with Rafael Grossi, Director-General of the IAEA, strongly condemned the attack and reaffirmed that targeting civilian facilities and vital infrastructure constitutes a flagrant violation of international law.

Sheikh Abdullah stressed the UAE's full right to respond to such terrorist attacks and to take all necessary measures to protect its security, territorial integrity and citizens in accordance with international law.

He also reaffirmed the UAE's commitment to supporting the IAEA's pivotal role in promoting nuclear safety and security regionally and internationally.

The attack drew strong regional condemnation. Egypt and Jordan condemned the attack and described it as a serious escalation and a clear violation of the UAE's sovereignty and international law. The Arab League Secretary-General Ahmed Aboul Gheit also condemned the attack.

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